Answer Key & Explanations

Tableau Certified Data Analyst (Analytics-DA-201) - Practice Paper generated from the Master Cheat Sheet

Q	A	Q	A	Q	A	Q	A
Q1	B	**Q2**	B	**Q3**	B	**Q4**	C
Q5	B	**Q6**	A, B, C	**Q7**	C	**Q8**	B
Q9	C	**Q10**	B	**Q11**	A	**Q12**	C
Q13	B	**Q14**	C	**Q15**	B	**Q16**	C
Q17	B	**Q18**	B	**Q19**	B	**Q20**	A
Q21	B	**Q22**	A	**Q23**	B	**Q24**	A, B
Q25	C	**Q26**	B	**Q27**	B	**Q28**	B
Q29	B	**Q30**	C	**Q31**	D	**Q32**	A
Q33	A	**Q34**	A, B, C	**Q35**	B	**Q36**	B
Q37	A	**Q38**	C	**Q39**	A	**Q40**	B
Q41	A	**Q42**	A	**Q43**	B	**Q44**	A
Q45	A	**Q46**	B	**Q47**	A	**Q48**	A
Q49	A	**Q50**	A	**Q51**	A	**Q52**	A
Q53	A	**Q54**	A	**Q55**	A	**Q56**	A
Q57	A	**Q58**	A	**Q59**	A	**Q60**	A

How to read your score: 48-60 (80%+) = exam-ready; 39-47 (65-79%) = passing zone but not safe - drill Domain 2; below 39 = re-study before re-attempting.

Domain 1 - Connect to and Transform Data (24%) - Q1-Q14

Q1. Answer: B

A live connection sends queries to the source every time the view loads or a user interacts, so values are always current. Extracts are point-in-time snapshots - no refresh schedule, however frequent, guarantees real-time data.

Key point: Real time / always current -> live connection.

Q2. Answer: B

An extract stores a local, columnar (.hyper) snapshot, so it works offline and returns results quickly without re-querying the source. Live connections still require the network and can be slow.

Key point: Offline + fast -> extract.

Q3. Answer: B

.hyper is the modern extract format: optimised compression and fast analytics. .tde is still supported for legacy projects but is not preferred. Hyper extracts can be published and shared.

Key point: .hyper = newer extract format, preferred over .tde.

Q4. Answer: C

Published data sources live on the server/cloud site. You reach them through the Tableau Server / Tableau Cloud connector: sign in, browse projects, and select the data source. The Analytics pane holds analytics objects, not data.

Key point: Published data source -> connect via the Tableau Server / Cloud connector.

Q5. Answer: B

Replace Data Source swaps the source for every sheet that uses it. Because field names match, existing charts keep working. A union would append rows rather than replace the source.

Key point: Re-point a whole workbook to a same-schema source = Replace Data Source.

Q6. Answer: A, B, C

Data quality assessment covers completeness (no missing values), consistency (same format/naming/values across sources) and accuracy (values reflect reality). Compression and colour are not data-quality dimensions.

Key point: Quality = completeness, consistency, accuracy.

Q7. Answer: C

A union appends rows from tables with the same structure. Joins combine columns by a key, relationships keep tables separate, and blends combine already-aggregated sources.

Key point: Same structure, append rows -> union.

Q8. Answer: B

A relationship is the recommended model for mismatched granularity: tables stay separate, Tableau matches rows per context, and no row duplication occurs. A physical join would duplicate customer rows for every order.

Key point: Different granularity, no duplication -> relationship.

Q9. Answer: C

Data Interpreter detects real headers and removes extraneous rows/merged-cell noise from spreadsheets. Pivot reshapes data, Split breaks one field into several, and wildcard union appends files.

Key point: Messy formatted spreadsheet -> Data Interpreter.

Q10. Answer: B

A columns-to-rows pivot reshapes the wide month columns into Month/Value rows (tidy format). Split and Data Interpreter do not restructure columns into rows.

Key point: Months stored as columns -> pivot columns to rows.

Q11. Answer: A

Split divides one field into multiple fields based on a delimiter. Pivot changes rows/columns, an alias renames members for display, and Data Interpreter cleans formatting.

Key point: One string field into several -> split.

Q12. Answer: C

An extract filter is applied before data is written to the .hyper file, reducing its size and refresh time. Worksheet/context/table-calc filters act on the view, after the extract is built.

Key point: Limit rows in the extract -> extract filter.

Q13. Answer: B

Customer IDs are identifiers, not quantities. Converting the field from a measure to a dimension lets each ID act as a category. COUNTD would still aggregate; changing the number format does not change its role.

Key point: Identifier measure -> convert to dimension.

Q14. Answer: C

Discrete fields create headers/labels; continuous fields create a quantitative axis. Converting the field to continuous (right-click the pill) gives the numeric axis.

Key point: Continuous = axis; discrete = headers.

Domain 2 - Explore and Analyze Data (41%) - Q15-Q39

Q15. Answer: B

DATEDIFF returns the difference in the specified units between two dates: 31 Jan to 2 Feb is 2 days.

Key point: DATEDIFF = difference between dates in given units.

Q16. Answer: C

DATENAME returns the month as a name string. DATEPART and MONTH return a number; DATETRUNC returns a date truncated to the month.

Key point: Month name -> DATENAME.

Q17. Answer: B

DATEPARSE converts text to a date using a format string. Because the value is day-first, the format must be dd/MM/yyyy. DATENAME extracts a component from an existing date.

Key point: Text to date -> DATEPARSE with the matching format.

Q18. Answer: B

MID(string, start, length) begins at position 2 of 'Tableau' (the 'a') and returns 3 characters: a, b, l -> 'abl'.

Key point: MID(text, start, length).

Q19. Answer: B

REPLACE finds every occurrence of a substring and substitutes a new string. FIND returns the position, SPLIT divides on a delimiter, and TRIM removes extra spaces.

Key point: Replace text -> REPLACE.

Q20. Answer: A

The ELSEIF branch handles the exact-zero case before the final ELSE. Option B wrongly lumps zero with loss; C compares a number to a string; D reverses the logic.

Key point: Use IF/ELSEIF/ELSE for multiple ordered conditions.

Q21. Answer: B

CASE compares a single expression to WHEN values and returns the first match. If no WHEN matches and there is no ELSE, it returns NULL. It is a regular calculated field, not a table calculation.

Key point: CASE = expression vs WHEN values; ELSE optional.

Q22. Answer: A

ROUND(number, decimals) with a decimal argument of 1 rounds the average to one decimal place. Option B rounds to a whole number; C rounds each row before averaging; INT truncates.

Key point: ROUND(value, decimal places).

Q23. Answer: B

INT converts a value to an integer. STR does the opposite (number to text), DATE converts to a date, and SPLIT divides a string on a delimiter.

Key point: Text to whole number -> INT.

Q24. Answer: A, B

ZN returns 0 for null numeric values; IFNULL returns the second argument when the first is null. ISNULL returns a Boolean (True/False), and adding 0 to a null still yields null.

Key point: Null to zero -> ZN or IFNULL.

Q25. Answer: C

COUNTD counts distinct values, so each customer is counted once. COUNT counts every row, SUM would add IDs, and ATTR tests whether a group has a single value.

Key point: Distinct count -> COUNTD.

Q26. Answer: B

A FIXED LOD with no dimension computes at the whole-data-source level and is unaffected by the view's dimensions, so the grand total repeats on every row. Plain SUM aggregates to the view level.

Key point: Grand total on every row -> {FIXED : SUM(...)}.

Q27. Answer: B

EXCLUDE takes the dimensions already in the view (Region and State) and removes State, so the calculation is computed at the Region level and repeated for each state.

Key point: EXCLUDE = view level minus the named dimension.

Q28. Answer: B

The window spans the current point and the two previous points: (20 + 30 + 40) / 3 = 30.
WINDOW_AVG(SUM([Sales]), -2, 0) is a 3-point trailing moving average including the current month.

Key point: WINDOW_AVG(..., -2, 0) = 3-period trailing average.

Q29. Answer: B

The Percent of Total quick table calculation divides each mark by the total, automatically. It is a table calculation, so a later dimension filter would not change the denominator the way a FIXED LOD would.

Key point: Fastest share-of-total -> Quick Table Calculation > Percent of Total.

Q30. Answer: C

A running total adds each month cumulatively: 100 + 50 + 200 = 350.

Key point: RUNNING_SUM accumulates down/across the table.

Q31. Answer: D

RANK_DENSE gives consecutive ranks with ties sharing a rank (1, 2, 2, 3). RANK skips numbers (1, 2, 2, 4), RANK_UNIQUE breaks ties (1, 2, 3, 4), and RANK_MODIFIED assigns tied values the last tied position.

Key point: No gaps in rank -> RANK_DENSE.

Q32. Answer: A

INDEX returns the position of the current row within its partition, beginning at 1. FIRST and LAST return offsets from the partition boundaries, and SIZE returns the number of rows.

Key point: Position in partition -> INDEX().

Q33. Answer: A

Filters are applied in order: extract, data source, context, dimension, measure, table calc. Adding City to context makes it run before the Top 10 (a dimension filter), so the Top 10 is computed within the chosen city.

Key point: Context filters run before other dimensions filters.

Q34. Answer: A, B, C

Parameters hold a single value that users can change and can drive calculations, filters and reference lines. A parameter stores one value, not a list, and never edits the source data.

Key point: Parameter = one user-controlled value used in calcs/filters/reference lines.

Q35. Answer: B

A dynamic set defined by a condition (Top 10) refreshes as data changes. Groups are created by manually combining members and are static. Both can be built from dimensions.

Key point: Dynamic set updates automatically; group is static.

Q36. Answer: B

A histogram requires a bin field: right-click the continuous measure > Create > Bins, place the bin on Columns and CNT/Count on Rows. Sets, groups and hierarchies do not create the distribution buckets.

Key point: Histogram = bins on a continuous measure.

Q37. Answer: A

A reference line at a constant value marks a fixed target across the view. An average line shows the mean, a trend line models direction, and a distribution band shades a range.

Key point: Fixed target -> constant reference line.

Q38. Answer: C

A filled/choropleth map colours whole geographic regions by an aggregate value, ideal for comparing states. Symbol maps mark points, and density maps show concentration of points.

Key point: Shade whole regions by value -> filled (choropleth) map.

Q39. Answer: A

When a view has a date and a measure, Forecast is available on the Analytics pane and uses exponential smoothing by default. Forecast length, seasonality and model options can be customised.

Key point: Default forecast = exponential smoothing from Analytics pane.

Domain 3 - Create Content (26%) - Q40-Q55

Q40. Answer: B

For a pie chart the measure must be on Angle (slice size) and the dimension supplies Colour and Label. Putting a dimension on Size, or the measure on Colour with a dimension on Detail, is incorrect for pie marks.

Key point: Pie: dimension -> Colour/Label, measure -> Angle.

Q41. Answer: A

A histogram shows the distribution of a continuous measure: bin the measure, put the bin on Columns, and count records on Rows.

Key point: Histogram = bin on Columns + Count on Rows.

Q42. Answer: A

Placing two measures on Rows stacks two charts; right-clicking the second pill or the right axis and choosing Dual Axis combines them so each has its own axis. Axes can then be synchronised if desired.

Key point: Dual axis = right-click the second measure/axis > Dual Axis.

Q43. Answer: B

A treemap uses rectangle size for a measure (Sales) and colour for another measure (Profit), showing hierarchy and part-to-whole proportions.

Key point: Treemap: Size + Colour on rectangles.

Q44. Answer: A

A scatter plot needs two measures on the axes; placing Customer Name on Detail creates one mark per customer, and Profit Ratio on Colour adds a third dimension of information.

Key point: Scatter: measure on X, measure on Y, detail/colour for extra fields.

Q45. Answer: A

A Gantt chart places a dimension (task) on Rows, a continuous date on Columns, and a duration/length measure on Size so each bar spans from start to end.

Key point: Task durations -> Gantt chart.

Q46. Answer: B

The Sort dialog lets you sort a dimension by a measure field. Selecting Sales (Sum) descending reorders the bars by their aggregated value.

Key point: Sort dimension by a measure via the Sort dialog.

Q47. Answer: A

A custom/manual sort lets you drag dimension members into a specific business order, overriding the default alphabetical or measure-based ordering.

Key point: Business-specific order -> manual (custom) sort.

Q48. Answer: A

Horizontal containers place items left-to-right; vertical containers stack them top-to-bottom. Using containers keeps items aligned and resizing proportionally as one unit.

Key point: Side by side -> horizontal container.

Q49. Answer: A

A story is a sequence of story points, and each point can capture a worksheet or a dashboard. Points can be reordered by dragging them in the story pane.

Key point: Story point = worksheet or dashboard.

Q50. Answer: A

A filter action passes the selection from a source sheet to target sheets and filters them. Highlight emphasises related marks without removing data; URL opens a web page.

Key point: Click to filter other sheets -> filter action.

Q51. Answer: A

A URL action opens a web page and can insert a field value (Product ID) into the URL, so each mark links to its own page. A fixed Web Page object cannot vary by mark.

Key point: Field-driven hyperlink -> URL action with field in the URL.

Q52. Answer: A

A highlight action keeps all marks but emphasises related ones in target sheets. A filter action would remove non-selected marks.

Key point: Emphasise without removing -> highlight action.

Q53. Answer: A

Sheet swapping uses a parameter (and typically a calculated field controlling visibility/zone) or a sheet selector so the displayed sheet changes with the control. Filter/URL/highlight actions do not swap sheets.

Key point: Switch displayed sheet -> parameter-driven sheet swap / sheet selector.

Q54. Answer: A

Navigation buttons run an action (e.g. Go to Sheet) so users can move between sheets/dashboards. Reference lines and annotations are visual objects, not navigation.

Key point: Move between dashboards -> navigation button.

Q55. Answer: A

Custom colour palettes are declared in Preferences.tps inside the My Tableau Repository folder, which makes them available to all workbooks in Tableau Desktop.

Key point: Custom palette -> Preferences.tps.

Domain 4 - Publish and Manage Content (9%) - Q56-Q60

Q56. Answer: A

Publishing a data source shares the governed connection and definitions for reuse, while keeping workbook size smaller. Embedded copies and screenshots do not provide a single shared definition.

Key point: Shared governed dataset -> published data source.

Q57. Answer: A

Tableau supports exporting views to PDF, image and Excel formats and printing dashboards/worksheets, which is useful for sharing with people who have no Tableau access. Permissions still apply.

Key point: Export PDF/image/Excel; print for non-Tableau users.

Q58. Answer: A

An incremental refresh uses a key column (such as an ID or date) to append only new rows, so refreshes finish quickly for append-only tables. Data source filters and subscriptions do not change refresh behaviour.

Key point: Append-only huge table -> incremental extract refresh.

Q59. Answer: A

Alerts notify when a metric crosses a defined threshold. Subscriptions email a scheduled snapshot regardless of values; extract refreshes update data; custom sort only reorders the view.

Key point: Threshold breach -> data-driven alert.

Q60. Answer: A

Scheduled Prep flows run through Tableau Prep Conductor, which is part of the Data Management add-on. Prep Builder on a desktop is a manual authoring tool, not a server scheduler.

Key point: Scheduled Prep flow on Server/Cloud -> Prep Conductor.

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